



INTEGRATING GOOGLE APP ENGINE AND ECLIPSE

Ever wondered what Google App Engine and cloud computing is all about? Here's an easy way to try it out, by integrating it with Eclipse. It makes everything much simpler if you get some hands on experience of your first application on the cloud framework.

Creating and optimising a Web application is a task in itself, let alone managing and getting up to speed with application servers, while taking care of load-balancing and scalability issues. All this setting up and configuration take a toll on actual development. Why not have a framework that allows you to create Web applications and just forget about the rest?

Here is Google App Engine, which allows us to develop applications on its platform, and conveniently allows easy management—with the potential to run our applications on 'Google-scale infrastructure'. (You know what that means, and the kind of reliability it represents!) This not only gives you a lower time-to-market for your product, but also considerably decreases maintenance and development costs. In short, it is one of the best Platform-as-a-service (PaaS) cloud computing services available out there.

Google App Engine is a product best supported on Python, along with Java—and Google's new Go language is currently an additional and experimental feature. Since I am more familiar with Java, I will only be able to explain things from the Java perspective; variations in other languages are easier to grasp if you have sufficient knowledge in that field.

App Engine provides standard Java APIs, along with some that are specific to this environment. It is understood that if you want to make your application portable to other Web application containers, you should steer clear of these App Engine-specific APIs.

The Jetty servlet container is used to host applications, and supports the Java Servlet API up to version 2.4. It provides access to databases via Java Data Objects (JDO) and the Java Persistence API (JPA).